

TV SHOW

Stranger Things 3: Thrice the action, drama and romance

★★★★☆ | Stranger Things worried fans when Season 2 didn't quite the calibre of the fantastic first season. However, with Season 3, the show is back with a bang. The storyline, like previous seasons, features a lurking evil in the small town of Hawkins, this time, from a murky, Russian-infiltrated science lab. At the end of Season 2, it seemed like Eleven (Millie Bobby Brown) trapped the Mind Flayer inside the Upside Down and closed the gate/portal behind the threat. However, it appears that part of this creature continues to linger on in Hawkins and the Russians labouriously attempt to open up the gate El shut last time around.

The Mind Flayer threatens the lives of the people of Hawkins and the kids, all grown-up and hormonal teenagers now,



delve into the dangerous mission of 'saving the world'. In the background of all this terror, we see evolutions of characters and relationships. El and Mike (Finn Wolfhard) are pretty much inseparable until Hopper (David Harbour), who has taken up complete parenthood of El now, intervenes and causes tension between the couple. El's relationship with Max (Sadie Sink) is a major highlight, with Max encouraging El to find her true self apart from Mike by getting some much-needed distance and... shopping! El proudly becomes her own self and has standout moments, including learning a new word 'b*tchin'.

Steve (Joe Keery), on the other hand, is working a summer job as an ice cream scooper alongside a new character Robin (Maya Hawke). A revelation about her character towards the end of the season proves to be one of the most impactful points of the season. Dustin (Gaten Matarazzo) and Erica (Priah Ferguson), join the

ice cream scooper duo to form an unlikely team that work to bust the Russian base and the dangers inside it. One of the most touching moments in the season was when Hopper, new to the parenting world, turns to Joyce (Winona Ryder) for advice to deal with El and Mike's closeness. Their chemistry throughout the season is fiery, infuriating, and hilarious. Nancy (Natalia Dyer) and Jonathan (Charlie Heaton) now work for the Hawkins Post and follow a lead to some eerie events taking place in Hawkins despite being measly interns and having to deal with their naysaying bosses. Billy (the bully?) is now a lifeguard, but his summer job quickly takes a backseat since he is the latest victim of the Mind Flayer in this season and attempts to assemble an army or sorts for the Mind Flayer, who all eventually, make the monster that much more threatening.

All in all, the season has a little bit and a lot of everything. Relationship drama, multiple odd pair-ups, humour, touching moments, spookiness, action and horror. The best part? Every character seems to have a part to play in the grand events that unfold towards the end of the season. The build-up is fantastic, the pacing never seems rushed and every group which has separated to play their own part in the season, meet back together towards the end to face the threat jointly.

MOVIE

Spider-Man: Far From Home

★★★★☆ | The final movie in phase 3 of the Marvel Cinematic Universe, Spider-Man: Far From Home served as more of a giant post-script than a Spider-Man movie. This is no way means that we thought the movie sucked. It didn't. As far as Marvel movies go, it was actually decent. What we're saying is that it simply didn't feel like a Spider-Man movie; it didn't have the same feeling as Spider-Man: Homecoming, or even Into the Spiderverse did for



that matter. This movie was more of an, in memoriam of Tony Stark, if you will.

Anyway, moving on to the movie itself, they did a great job with the trailers, even had people who had read the

comics beforehand fooled. As to what it was that fooled everyone, that's spoiler territory, so we won't get into that. They did put a lot of effort into maintaining the verity of the trailers until the movie came out. You won't find any of the actors messing up in any of their pre-release interviews.

Now for the bits of the movie that did focus on Spider-Man, we see Peter tussling with himself to keep his superhero life and normal life apart. We also see how he deals with the loss of another father figure in his life, Tony Stark. A lot of it is just about how Peter is ultimately still a teenager who still goes to high school and has all the same problems to worry about, in addition to having to save the world as well. Oh and, then there's the post-credits scene, we didn't see that coming, it was a nice set-up for phase 4 of the MCU.